

RESOLUTION NO. _____

ENTITLED: "A RESOLUTION AUTHORIZING THE CITY OF CHEYENNE BOARD OF PUBLIC UTILITIES TO DISCHARGE UNCOLLECTIBLE DEBTS PURSUANT TO WYOMING STATUTE 16-4-502."

WHEREAS, Wyoming Statute 16-4-502 provides for discharge of uncollectible debts upon proper certification to the Governing Body;

WHEREAS, the City Treasurer has prepared the required certification for uncollectible debts on the books of the Board of Public Utilities (Board), a copy of which is attached to and incorporated as part of this Resolution;

WHEREAS, the debts have been reviewed by the appropriate Board staff and collection efforts have failed; and

WHEREAS, the Board desires to remove the uncollectible debts from its books as expediently as possible.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED BY THE GOVERNING BODY OF THE CITY OF CHEYENNE, WYOMING, that the City Treasurer is authorized to discharge the uncollectible debts in the amount of fourteen thousand one hundred ninety-five dollars and twenty-eight cents (\$14,195.28) from the books of the City of Cheyenne Board of Public Utilities.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that this resolution shall be effective upon passage and execution by the mayor and city clerk.

PRESENTED, READ AND ADOPTED this _____ day of _____, 2024.

Patrick Collins, Mayor

(SEAL)

ATTEST:

Kristina F. Jones, City Clerk

Customer	Name	Address	Water	Sewer	Misc Fees	2% City Assessment	BOPU total	Bill Due Date	Aged off last bill due date	Reason
506,060	MOORE, DONALD	1007 25TH			\$ 10.41		\$ 10.41	4/27/1994	30.20	Greater than 4 years old
511,925	MARKS, RACHAEL	1014 CREST PARK	\$ 38.02				\$ 38.02	4/1/1997	27.27	Greater than 4 years old
516,837	MILLER, ROD	6635 BOMAR	\$ 26.00				\$ 26.00	2/28/2000	24.35	Greater than 4 years old
505,367	ARGERIS, GEORGE	3619 CAREY	\$ 0.05				\$ 0.05	1/17/2006	18.46	Greater than 4 years old
532,452	PARKSIDE HOMES	DAKOTA DR x SHENANDOAH ST	\$ 2.00				\$ 2.00	9/11/2006	17.81	Greater than 4 years old
532,249	WESTLAND HOLDINGS	422 STAMPEDE	\$ 3.97				\$ 3.97	3/5/2008	16.33	Greater than 4 years old
510,012	SCHEMP, WILLERT R	1706 OXFORD			\$ 30.00		\$ 30.00	8/22/2012	11.86	Greater than 4 years old
507,692	MCDONALDS RESTAURANT	2515 LINCOLNWAY	\$ 4.99				\$ 4.99	7/29/2013	10.93	Greater than 4 years old
542,373	KRUSECK, RYAN	4601 BIG SUR	\$ 41.80	\$ 163.51			\$ 205.31	11/14/2016	7.63	Greater than 4 years old
504,155	SARA, RICH	2916 REED	\$ 37.40	\$ 185.33			\$ 222.73	11/2/2017	6.66	Greater than 4 years old
551,058	MOORE, JAMES	901 PHOENIX	\$ 30.58	\$ 126.56			\$ 157.14	12/12/2018	5.55	Greater than 4 years old
545,656	OWSLEY, SEAN	2015 GETTYSBURG	\$ 38.23	\$ 59.78			\$ 98.01	12/20/2018	5.53	Greater than 4 years old
552,205	BOCANEGRA, DENA	2201 16TH	\$ 34.88	\$ 91.06	\$ 68.50		\$ 194.44	3/15/2019	5.30	Greater than 4 years old
554,348	GARRETT, DUANE	211 5TH	\$ 16.57	\$ 30.54	\$ 16.40		\$ 63.51	4/29/2019	5.18	Greater than 4 years old
507,925	DIFFENBAUGH, BRUCE	1008 FREMONT	\$ 51.26	\$ 45.95			\$ 97.21	6/11/2019	5.06	Greater than 4 years old
548,963	SMITH, LINDSEY	822 RICHARDSON	\$ 20.20	\$ 30.31			\$ 50.51	6/19/2019	5.04	Greater than 4 years old
554,812	SHIELDS, MICHAEL	4409 RIO VERDE	\$ 82.75	\$ 39.98			\$ 122.73	6/21/2019	5.03	Greater than 4 years old
540,114	STERLING, ANTHONY	115 4TH	\$ 31.55	\$ 83.43			\$ 114.98	7/22/2019	4.95	Greater than 4 years old
544,128	CONSELATORE, FRANK	1530 GOPP	\$ 5.74	\$ 28.49			\$ 34.23	7/25/2019	4.94	Greater than 4 years old
556,043	NIKOLOV, NIKOLAI	1521 WILLOW	\$ 15.91	\$ 12.18			\$ 28.09	7/31/2019	4.92	Greater than 4 years old
546,334	M D TRUST LLC	508 9TH	\$ 120.45	\$ 85.49	\$ 52.90		\$ 258.84	8/6/2019	4.90	Greater than 4 years old
554,049	M D TRUST LLC	1000 LEISHER	\$ 73.05	\$ 60.21	\$ 36.20		\$ 169.46	8/8/2019	4.90	Greater than 4 years old
557,358	ETTESTAD, JAKE & KAYLA	2203 16TH	\$ 23.17	\$ 17.12			\$ 40.29	8/13/2019	4.88	Greater than 4 years old
556,075	BARR, PHILLIP	2609 9TH	\$ 51.93	\$ 90.19	\$ 3.00		\$ 145.12	8/13/2019	4.88	Greater than 4 years old
531,462	ADAMS, JAMES	303 ARKEL	\$ 79.43	\$ 64.86	\$ 3.00		\$ 147.29	9/5/2019	4.82	Greater than 4 years old
506,928	WILSON, D LEE	1415 ROLLINS	\$ 12.87	\$ 42.64			\$ 55.51	9/24/2019	4.77	Greater than 4 years old
550,451	MORSE, RICHMOND N & LINDSAY	1512 CORRAL	\$ 47.26	\$ 85.49	\$ 3.00		\$ 135.75	9/26/2019	4.76	Greater than 4 years old
532,705	M D TRUST	109 DERR	\$ 28.25	\$ 59.62	\$ 22.40		\$ 110.27	9/30/2019	4.75	Greater than 4 years old
548,597	GUNTHER, GREG	3272 CAMPFIRE	\$ 106.27	\$ 147.07	\$ 36.20		\$ 289.54	10/2/2019	4.75	Greater than 4 years old
539,511	LOWE, NORMAN	609 PEBRICAN	\$ 16.96	\$ 90.05	\$ 86.10		\$ 193.11	10/2/2019	4.75	Greater than 4 years old
554,124	ROBINETT, CLINTON & CORAL	3534 SHENANDOAH	\$ 387.13	\$ 85.42			\$ 472.55	10/3/2019	4.75	Greater than 4 years old
515,765	MORAN, RONALD	5317 SYRACUSE	\$ 125.22	\$ 138.44	\$ 36.20		\$ 299.86	10/31/2019	4.67	Greater than 4 years old
535,590	JEWETT, KEVIN	2201 11TH	\$ 7.72	\$ 38.32			\$ 46.04	11/1/2019	4.67	Greater than 4 years old
536,001	CLARK, JENNIFER	1835 22ND	\$ 20.66	\$ 49.98			\$ 70.64	11/11/2019	4.64	Greater than 4 years old
508,161	FIELDS, MARSHALL	3062 HANSON	\$ 20.26	\$ 57.97			\$ 78.23	11/21/2019	4.61	Greater than 4 years old
552,373	DONNELLY, DARION & ELIZABETH	4100 INDEPENDENCE	\$ 8.45	\$ 20.64			\$ 29.09	11/26/2019	4.60	Greater than 4 years old
515,085	LARSON, INGRID	3402 CRIBBON	\$ 17.29	\$ 21.67			\$ 38.96	12/2/2019	4.58	Greater than 4 years old
555,704	MILLER, JEREMIAH	1814 18TH	\$ 59.66	\$ 83.16	\$ 36.20		\$ 179.02	12/3/2019	4.58	Greater than 4 years old
550,668	GRON STUGA RENTALS LLC	926 MCGOVERN	\$ 7.72	\$ 25.58			\$ 33.30	12/11/2019	4.56	Greater than 4 years old
530,345	TERRY, LEA MICHELLE	713 3RD	\$ 18.81	\$ 62.32	\$ 3.00		\$ 84.13	12/13/2019	4.55	Greater than 4 years old
529,953	SANDERS, JULIE & TRAVIS	3402 LUCKIE	\$ 95.62	\$ 164.94	\$ 17.47		\$ 278.03	12/13/2019	4.55	Greater than 4 years old
503,047	XIUYING LLC	1720 CAPITOL		\$ 46.39			\$ 46.39	12/17/2019	4.54	Greater than 4 years old
554,621	FLORES, IAN & CRYSTAL	1623 BLUES	\$ 23.36	\$ 69.40			\$ 92.76	12/20/2019	4.53	Greater than 4 years old
538,527	CHAPMAN, GEORGE & ERIN	3302 FIRE SIDE	\$ 10.30	\$ 51.11			\$ 61.41	12/24/2019	4.52	Greater than 4 years old
506,343	JANZEN, EDITH	1500 21ST	\$ 11.90	\$ 110.41			\$ 122.31	1/3/2020	4.49	Greater than 4 years old
539,514	LOWE, NORMAN	1923 EVANS	\$ 181.83	\$ 137.62	\$ 36.20		\$ 355.65	1/7/2020	4.48	Greater than 4 years old
533,544	MD TRUST LLC	112 DERR	\$ 14.30	\$ 87.12	\$ 37.10		\$ 138.52	1/10/2020	4.47	Greater than 4 years old
551,962	BUTLER, ANDREW & SCHELBY	1008 ADAMS	\$ 6.53	\$ 33.05			\$ 39.58	2/3/2020	4.41	Greater than 4 years old
551,873	JORDAN, DION	4717 HARMON	\$ 12.04	\$ 30.55			\$ 42.59	2/4/2020	4.41	Greater than 4 years old
557,287	MC LENDON, CODY J	4513 11TH	\$ 61.72	\$ 105.91	\$ 85.80		\$ 253.43	2/11/2020	4.39	Greater than 4 years old
550,712	JOHNSON, CLIFFORD	602 21ST	\$ 24.07	\$ 36.54			\$ 60.61	2/13/2020	4.38	Greater than 4 years old
548,618	DILLON, VICTORIA	1609 FREMONT	\$ 73.78	\$ 82.62	\$ 19.80		\$ 176.20	2/13/2020	4.38	Greater than 4 years old
553,546	PHILLIPS, DANA	3915 CRIBBON	\$ 64.87	\$ 59.89			\$ 124.76	3/19/2020	4.28	Greater than 4 years old

Customer	Name	Address	Water	Sewer	Misc Fees	2% City Assesment	BOPU total	Bill Due Date	Aged off last bill due date	Reason
553,207	CLARK, ARTHUR	2216 DILLON	\$ 38.15	\$ 29.51			\$ 67.66	4/8/2020	4.23	Greater than 4 years old
524,847	BEEDLE, DAVID	1808 ONEIL	\$ 34.25	\$ 32.87	\$ 3.00		\$ 70.12	4/15/2020	4.21	Greater than 4 years old
512,305	LEWIS, GLEN A	3503 MYERS	\$ 211.97	\$ 119.72			\$ 331.69	4/29/2020	4.17	Greater than 4 years old
553,236	MUNSON, DANIEL	618 26TH	\$ 27.20	\$ 99.45			\$ 126.65	5/11/2020	4.14	Greater than 4 years old
556,581	HOLMES, MATTHEW	603 CREIGHTON	\$ 90.43	\$ 88.69			\$ 179.12	5/28/2020	4.09	Greater than 4 years old
548,611	ESCO, TAMARA	4004 14TH	\$ 39.44	\$ 73.19			\$ 112.63	5/29/2020	4.09	Greater than 4 years old
553,368	DEEP SOUTH LLC	2105 LINCOLNWAY	\$ 236.85	\$ 247.14			\$ 483.99	6/1/2020	4.08	Greater than 4 years old
557,540	MIKE HAVILAND & MIRANDA BROWN	1115 29TH	\$ 75.86	\$ 82.62			\$ 158.48	6/1/2020	4.08	Greater than 4 years old
557,493	EVANS, DARRIAN	2005 17TH	\$ 16.93	\$ 85.71			\$ 102.64	6/12/2020	4.05	Greater than 4 years old
505,827	RAUERT, REX C	415 26TH	\$ 208.67	\$ 121.85			\$ 330.52	6/17/2020	4.04	Greater than 4 years old
504,762	BURKES, WILLIE J	2012 SNYDER	\$ 423.13	\$ 1,016.25	\$ 90.50	\$ 7.03	\$ 1,536.91	6/19/2020	4.03	Greater than 4 years old
	953 SUMMIT VIEW CONSTRUCTION	224 F QUARTER CIRCLE LOOP	\$ 691.30				\$ 691.30	2/21/2020	4.36	Greater than 4 years old
	232 BRIANNE CUSTOM BUILDERS	6312 BIG SKY TRAIL	\$ 36.91				\$ 36.91	2/21/2020	4.36	Greater than 4 years old
	84 OXBOW EXCAVATIONS	812 MARYLAND COURT	\$ 193.91				\$ 193.91	6/22/2020	4.02	Greater than 4 years old
509,334	CLARK, HERBERT J	2802 DEMING	\$ 1,275.81	\$ 33.71			\$ 1,309.52	9/15/2022	1.79	Deceased
511,259	GASKILL, CAROL	1025 MONROE	\$ 8.57	\$ 14.53			\$ 23.10	10/31/2022	1.67	Deceased
504,123	NATION, BILL	3016 AMES	\$ 15.86	\$ 80.27	\$ 3.15		\$ 99.28	11/17/2022	1.62	Deceased
553,441	KOPACK SR, CHARLES A	2219 11TH	\$ 21.00	\$ 106.29	\$ 3.15		\$ 130.44	1/19/2023	1.45	Deceased
558,281	BURNETTE, MELVIN	3568 BOSTON	\$ 56.64	\$ 57.92	\$ 3.31	\$ 2.29	\$ 120.16	3/2/2023	1.33	Deceased
504,732	LACOMBE, DAN	614 21ST	\$ 149.71	\$ 228.35	\$ 48.89	\$ 7.55	\$ 434.50	3/8/2023	1.32	Deceased
527,207	RANDY SCHRADER ESTATE	726 COTTONWOOD	\$ 35.76	\$ 156.04	\$ 40.75	\$ 3.84	\$ 236.39	3/16/2023	1.29	Deceased
513,725	MACKEY, MARTHA	4764 MAPLE	\$ 81.38	\$ 197.44	\$ 40.91	\$ 5.60	\$ 325.33	3/23/2023	1.27	Deceased
518,989	BOYER, DIANE	5338 HACKER	\$ 115.02				\$ 115.02	3/23/2023	1.27	Deceased
510,170	HANSEN, BEVERLEY	3533 ALEXANDER	\$ 9.64	\$ 14.69		\$ 0.50	\$ 24.83	6/7/2023	1.07	Deceased
515,032	OSBORNE, EDWARD W	3731 MCCOMB	\$ 10.13	\$ 54.00		\$ 1.29	\$ 65.42	6/22/2023	1.02	Deceased
514,760	TROYER, LAWRENCE	4202 CLARK	\$ 10.80	\$ 37.57		\$ 0.97	\$ 49.34	8/17/2023	0.87	Deceased
540,337	SWAN, JIM R	1011 WARREN	\$ 121.79	\$ 268.28	\$ 108.74	\$ 1.45	\$ 500.26	10/19/2023	0.70	Deceased
531,095	BROOMALL, W L	1012 BALDWIN	\$ 0.20	\$ 1.54			\$ 1.74	7/2/2020	4.00	De minimis
559,278	MONUMENT HOMEBUILDERS	1337 ALYSSA		\$ 3.00			\$ 3.00	7/6/2020	3.99	De minimis
561,456	GESPINOCA, MAYELI	100 MIAMI	\$ 0.20	\$ 1.03			\$ 1.23	9/30/2020	3.75	De minimis
516,073	MITCHELL, AMANDA K	208 CARROLL		\$ 3.56			\$ 3.56	10/12/2020	3.72	De minimis
509,908	PALESE, NICHOLAS R	3521 BOSTON			\$ 3.00		\$ 3.00	11/4/2020	3.65	De minimis
510,879	GIRARD, DARRELL	4517 6TH	\$ 4.49	\$ 7.62			\$ 12.11	11/24/2020	3.60	De minimis
557,432	PARRISH, DUSTIN & MADISON	6515 KICKING HORSE	\$ 3.47	\$ 17.55			\$ 21.02	12/18/2020	3.53	De minimis
538,313	PEREA, PAMELA	1025 MANDOLIN	\$ 4.28	\$ 18.08			\$ 22.36	2/19/2021	3.36	De minimis
539,060	RUSSELL, MARK & ANNA	4000 GOLDEN	\$ 0.20	\$ 1.03			\$ 1.23	3/25/2021	3.27	De minimis
530,600	WALTER, DEBBIE	4407 SPRINGER	\$ 4.28	\$ 18.08			\$ 22.36	3/30/2021	3.25	De minimis
535,078	SHOOK, CORY & NICOLE	1931 GARRETT	\$ 3.26	\$ 16.52			\$ 19.78	4/22/2021	3.19	De minimis
513,120	PLYE, MICHAEL	900 GETTYSBURG	\$ 8.36	\$ 14.19			\$ 22.55	5/13/2021	3.13	De minimis
545,873	SAFEGUARD PROPERTIES	657 CREIGHTON	\$ 11.83	\$ 10.10			\$ 21.93	6/10/2021	3.06	De minimis
565,294	LYNN BUYS HOUSES LLC	5609 LAWRENCE				\$ 0.36	\$ 0.36	10/13/2022	1.72	De minimis
512,141	NAUGHTON, MARY	720 EVERGLADE	\$ 0.22	\$ 0.19		\$ 0.01	\$ 0.42	3/31/2023	1.25	De minimis
534,725	NOLAND, MICHAEL	1125 JEFFERSON	\$ 6.30				\$ 6.30	4/24/2023	1.19	De minimis
601,586	C AND T CONSTRUCTION	2120 GOODNIGHT	\$ 0.90			\$ 0.02	\$ 0.92	5/2/2023	1.16	De minimis
518,997	MAY, JACQUELYNN	5417 AKES				\$ 0.55	\$ 0.55	10/31/2023	0.67	De minimis
607,357	MOUNTAIN PRIME 2018	108 ARP				\$ 0.51	\$ 0.51	12/11/2023	0.55	De minimis
554,040	MATKOVICH, KYRA & SCOTT	219 PATTON				\$ 0.66	\$ 0.66	4/8/2024	0.23	De minimis
Report Total			\$ 6,579.88	\$ 6,597.49	\$ 985.28	\$ 32.63	\$ 14,195.28			
Allocation of Misc Fees			\$ 492.64	\$ 492.64	\$ (985.28)	\$ -	\$ -			
Fund Total			\$ 7,072.52	\$ 7,090.13	\$ -	\$ 32.63	\$ 14,195.28			



Board of Public Utilities

Cheyenne Water and Sewer Departments

2416 Snyder Ave.
Cheyenne, Wyoming 82001
(307) 637-6460
www.cheyennebopu.org

To: City of Cheyenne City Council

From: Cheyenne Board of Public Utilities

Re: Uncollectible Accounts Process- FY2024

On May 20, 2024, the Cheyenne Board of Public Utilities Board of Directors approved to write off \$14,195.28 in uncollectible accounts. In accordance with City of Cheyenne Resolution 4970, debts owed to the City that are at least four years old, the customer is deceased, or their debts have been discharged in bankruptcy are considered "uncollectible".

The below table provides a summary of the amount considered uncollectible by fiscal year and as a percentage of combined water and sewer sales.

Fiscal Year End of Bill Due Date	BOPU total	Combined Water and Sewer Sales	% of Sales to Bad Debt
Up to 2018	\$543.48	\$ 33,605,944.00	0.002%
2019	\$783.55	\$ 32,392,501.00	0.002%
2020	\$9,269.07	\$ 34,543,781.00	0.027%
Deceased	\$3,433.59		
De Minimis	\$165.59		
Total Requested Write Off	\$14,195.28		
Water Charges	\$ 6,579.88		
Sewer Charges	\$ 6,597.49		
Late/Misc Fees/Charges	\$ 1,017.91		
Total amount requested to be written off	\$ 14,195.28		

The BOPU FY 2024 budget includes \$20,000 in object code 5391 Bad Debt Expense split 50/50 between the Water and Sewer Funds. The 2023 AWWA Utility Benchmarking Survey reports median rate for uncollectible accounts for a combined water and wastewater utility is at .8%. BOPU is below the median rate based on the above calculation for FY 2020.

BOPU will continue to have its collection agency pursue collection on the above accounts until either statute of limitations is met, the customer is identified as deceased, or the customer's debt has been discharged thru bankruptcy and notification is provided to BOPU.

BOPU Billing and Collection Process for Active Customer Accounts

The BOPU bills its customers on a monthly basis. Customers' payments are due approximately 20 days after the bill date. A customer's bill is considered late when a payment has not been received by the time their next bill prints. This is approximately 5 days after the due date on a customer's monthly bill. Once a customer is



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considered late, a finance charge is applied to the customer's account thru the monthly billing process. A delinquency statement is included on a customer's monthly statement once a late penalty fee of \$3.30 has been applied. The below table provides further discussion/example regarding BOPU's process to collect on an active delinquent account.

Date	Activity
May 10, 2023	Customer statement is mailed for April usage
June 10, 2023	Customer statement is mailed for May usage and April's delinquent amount along with a billed late fee. Customer statement includes a delinquency shut off notice including date in red at the bottom of the bill.
July 1, 2023	Disconnect/shutoff phone call occurs. If customer service is unable to contact customer then a door card is dropped off at the property associated with the delinquent bill.
July 6, 2023	If no payment is received or payment plan set up, a disconnect/shutoff occurs and customer is billed a \$38.00 disconnect fee.
September 10, 2023	Customer account turned over to collections [Collection Center, Inc. (CCI)] after collection measures have been exhausted. This only occurs if the amount due is greater than \$30 and 120 days have passed since last customer payment].

Beyond the above timeline, BOPU attempts to contact customers via phone or email once their account becomes delinquent. During these attempted contacts, BOPU provides the customer with the opportunity to set up a payment plan to avoid shutoff. Typically, a customer is granted 1 payment plan every 6 months in an effort to help stop the customer being on the shutoff list monthly. If a customer does not pay, their account is considered suspended and will continue to accrue monthly service fees until the customer requests their meter be removed. Once a meter is removed, monthly service fees are stopped and the account balance no longer accrues additional charges.

BOPU Billing and Collection Process for a Finalized Account.

BOPU will initiate a final reading on a customer meter when notification of a transfer of ownership or change in tenant is received. At time of notification, BOPU attempts to receive updated contact information to ensure final bill is sent to former customers correct forwarding address. After a final reading occurs, the customer's account will be billed during the next billing cycle for the address. If no payment is received by the due date on the customer bill, the following process occurs:



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90 days after final bill- A collection letter is mailed to the customer with the final bill attached. The collection letter provides the customer with an additional copy of their unpaid bill but also puts them on notice the account will be sent to collections if not paid within 30 days.

120 days after final bill- At this point, we have exhausted all collection efforts and the customer account is turned over to our collection agency to begin their collection process if amount owed is greater than \$30. If account is under \$30, collection process halts unless customer calls to set up a new service.

Collection Company Fees- Based on BOPU's contract with Collection Centers, Inc, the fee for recovery is 25% of the customers account balance unless Collection Centers, Inc pursues legal action in which case the fee increases to 35%.

Property Foreclosures

Many properties are foreclosed on annually. BOPU only becomes aware of a foreclosure when we are notified by the former customer, a real estate agent or a mortgage lender. In many of these cases, the customer account is finalized thru the above process. BOPU then establishes a new customer account for the mortgage lender as they are now considered the property owner. Many mortgage lenders will elect to have BOPU enter the home and pull the water meter to stop all water and sewer charges. In other cases, BOPU will bill the mortgage lender like any other customer and send monthly statements to the address provided by the mortgage lender or address listed on the county assessor's website. BOPU follows the above described customer billing and collection processes for all mortgage lenders.

Tenant Accounts When Tenant Pays BOPU and Sanitation Charges

All property owner/manager/tenant accounts must include both the property owner and the tenant names on the account. This allows the BOPU to reduce the risk of non-payment as when a tenant moves out, the account reverts back to the property owner along with any amounts unpaid by the tenant. As protection to the property owner, a tenant is not allowed to have a payment plan without the property owner's approval. In addition, property owners are also notified when a customer account becomes delinquent. BOPU follows the above described customer billing and collection process for all property owner/manager/tenant accounts.

Bankruptcy

BOPU will not consider an account uncollectable until a copy of the formal discharge of the customer debt is provided by the customer or identified by our third party collection company. Once a delinquent account has been discharged through bankruptcy all collection efforts are stopped.

Deceased

BOPU will not consider a deceased customer's account as uncollectable until formal documentation is received, and transfer of property ownership occurs. The Cheyenne Board of Public Utilities will attempt to collect funds through the probate process if a notice of distribution of estate is provided to the Cheyenne Board of Public Utilities. If Cheyenne Board of Public Utilities is not notified of a customer being deceased, then the above collection process continues until notification occurs either from an estate representative or our third-party collection company. Once notification is received all collections efforts are stopped.

Other efforts occurred during FY 2024

Met with Black Hills Energy- BOPU staff met with Black Hills Energy customer account team to discuss their collection and shutoff practices as it relates to its Cheyenne customers. BOPU found that our collection practices were very similar. There are three primary differences to our collection/shutoff practices.



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- 1) Black Hills Energy uses a third-party to perform all calls associated with delinquent accounts. The third-party also sets up any payment plans with the customers based on their credit risk.
- 2) Black Hills Energy must follow the rules set out by the Wyoming Public Service Commission regarding disconnecting a customer's services. Based on Wyoming Statutes, BOPU's operating rules do not fall under these guidelines.
- 3) Black Hills Energy low-income customers qualify may qualify for the Low Income Home Energy Assistance Program (LIHEAP). Under the LIHEAP program, a customers current and delinquent bills may qualify for payment by the LIHEAP program operated by Wyoming Department of Family Services thru Align. BOPU low-income customers qualified for Low Income Housing Water Assistance Program (LIHWAP) during FY 2023, however, this was only a 1 year program that has not been renewed at the federal level.

Meeting with Collection Centers, Inc- BOPU staff along with City of Cheyenne staff met with Collection Centers, Inc. to discuss their practices as it relates to accounts sent to collections. Collection Center, Inc discussed their collection processes, collection philosophies and reviewed collection rates compared to national averages. During this call, we learned that BOPU is submitting accounts to collections in what they consider the sweet spot of 90 to 120 days delinquent. We also learned that Collection Centers, Inc has been able to collect on BOPU accounts at a rate above the national average for utilities. Finally, BOPU determined it was able to send accounts to collections if their bill was \$30 or greater compared to prior practice of \$50 or greater.

Tyler Notify- BOPU began using a new customer communication tool known as Tyler Notify in FY 2024. This tool allows BOPU's Customer Service Department to send automated communications to delinquent customers. The automated communication can only occur if a BOPU Customer Service Representative originates the message. The message can occur in the form of a phone call, text message or email. BOPU then reviews a communication response rate report to determine if further communication is required with a customer prior to a customer's water service being disconnected.

Electronic Campaign at 60 days on Finalized Accounts- BOPU is in the process of designing an electronic campaign (phone, text, email) for all customers accounts that have been finalized but are outstanding at the 60 day mark. This will reduce the costs of mailing a statement at the same time allowing for the customer to be contacted thru known communication method regarding their outstanding finalized bill.